

Convolution and Image Filtering

Credit: 1. Stephen F Elston, CSCI E-25 Computer Vision



HARVARD
Extension School

Credit: 2. S. Seitz

Image Filtering

Almost all computer vision pipelines require filtering

- Without good image data preparation even the most state of the art CV algorithms will not produce good results
- Classical filters apply the mathematical operation of **convolution**
 - Noise suppression
 - Edge and corner enhancement
 - Anti-aliasing
- We can understand the effects of filtering through **spectral analysis**
 - Filter changes power spectrum of image
 - Typical filters reduce high-frequency energy – noise
 - Higher frequency components include sharp edges and corners – typically blurred by filtering

Image Filtering

Key points for this lesson

- How convolution works in 1-d, 2-d and higher dimension
- How to apply padding, stride and tiling for convolution
- Constructing convolutional filter kernels
- The Fourier transform and frequency components of images
- The relationship between filtering and the spectrum of images

Convolution

Convolution

Convolution operations are a computationally efficient method of applying filters

- Convolutional kernel weights determine characteristics of filters
 - Filtering noise
 - Creating and enhancing features
- Convolutional filtering computationally efficient
 - High volume applications
 - Real-time CV

Convolution

Convolution operations are a computationally efficient method of applying filters

- Discrete convolutional kernels have a **span**, measured in points
- Kernel moves over image, a **stride length** at a time, producing filtered output
- Typically $\text{stride} \leq \text{span}$
- Tiled filters do not overlap, $\text{stride} = \text{span}$

Convolution

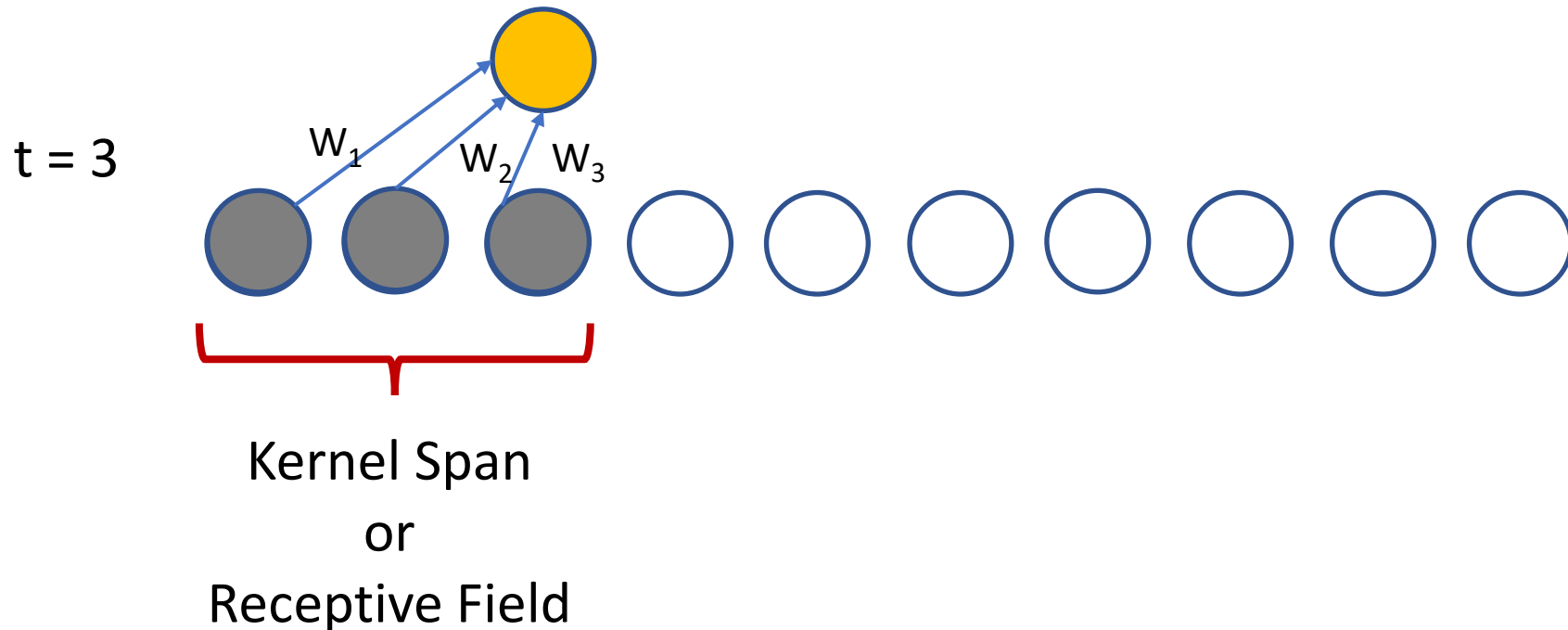
Convolution operations are a computationally efficient method of applying filters to discretely

- Convolution kernel is moved along the input tensor
 - Kernel has a small span compared to dimension of input tensor
 - Number of kernel dimensions $\leq$ number of input tensor dimensions
 - At each step a weighted output value is computed
 - Output tensor can have different number of dimensions from input tensor
- 1-D convolutions are a simple, but useful example
 - Time series data
 - Speech
 - Medical signals

1-D Convolution

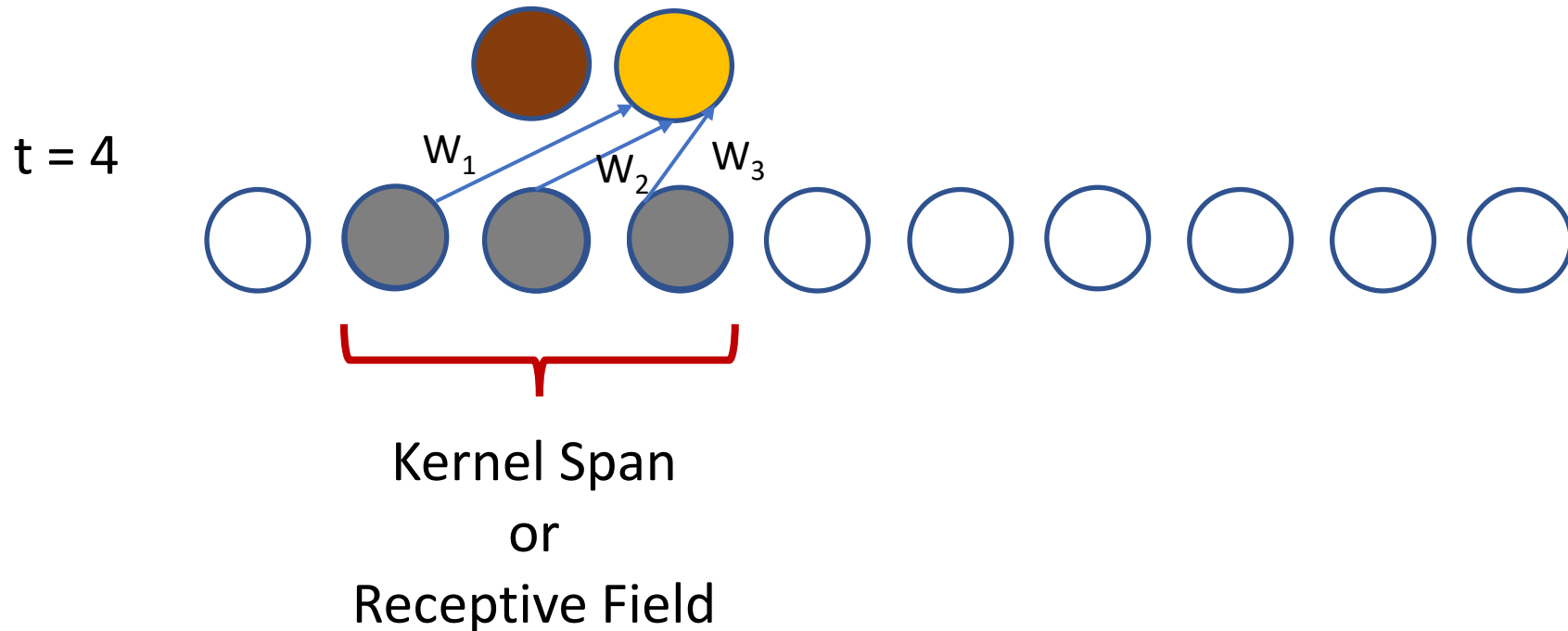
1-D CNNs are a simple, but useful example

- Consider a convolutional kernel with a **span** of 3 and **stride** 1
- Kernel defined by **weights** $[w_1, w_2, w_3]$
- The convolved value is the weighted sum over the span of the **convolutional kernel**



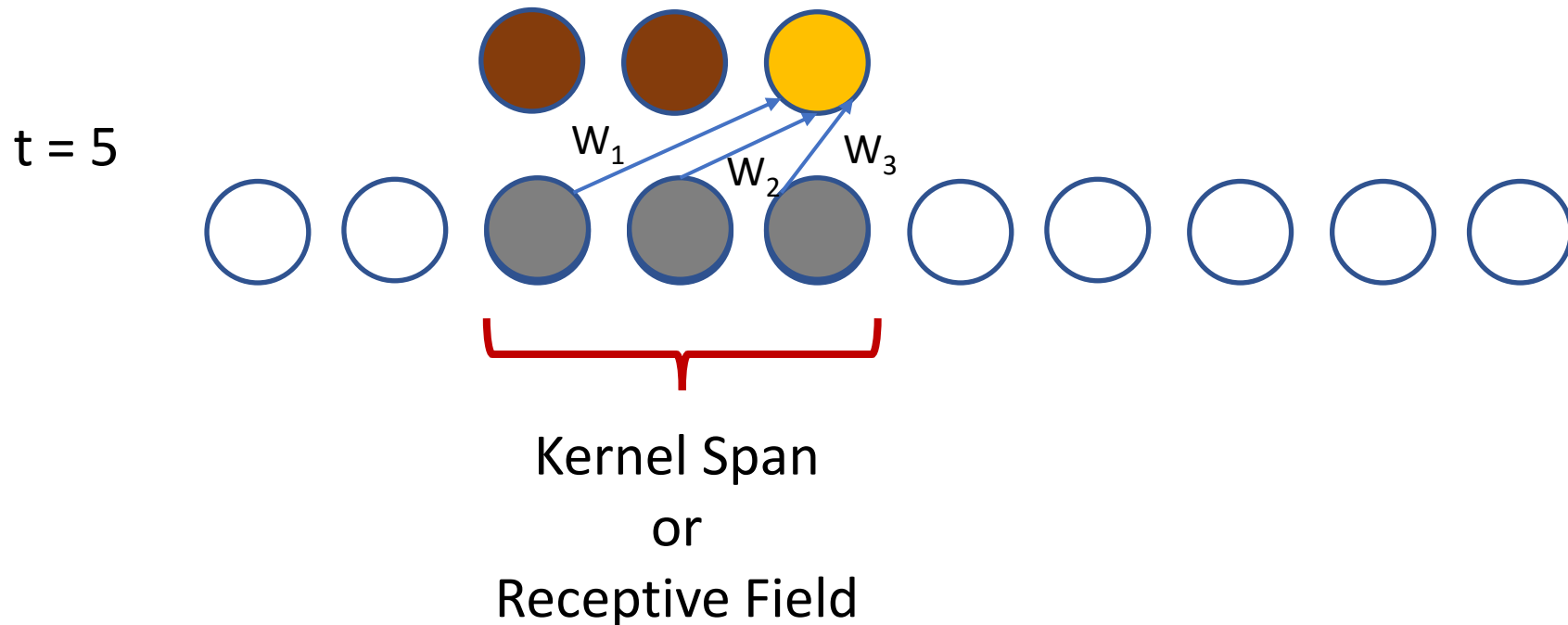
1-D Convolution

- 1-D CNNs are a simple, but useful example
- Move kernel by **stride** 1
- The convolutional kernel moves one sample per step



1-D Convolution

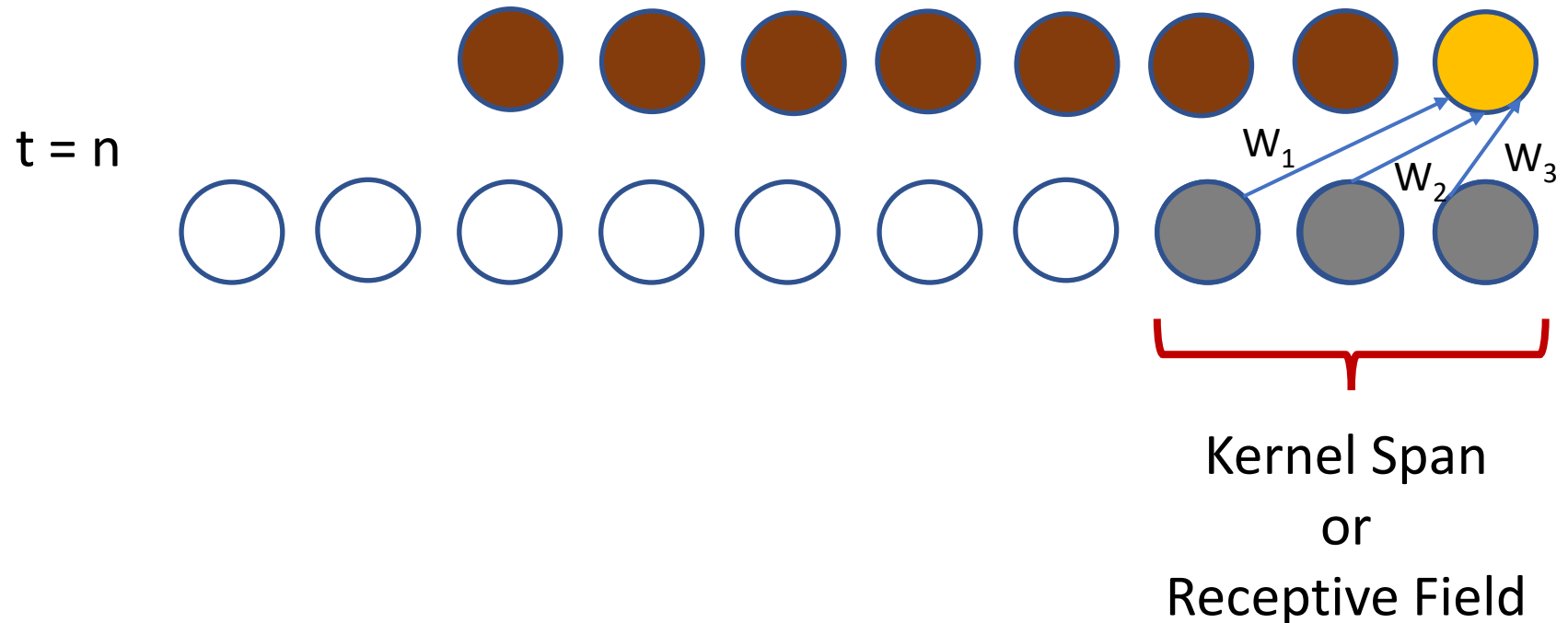
- 1-D CNNs are a simple, but useful example
- Continue to produce one output value per time step



1-D Convolution

1-D CNNs are a simple, but useful example

- Convolution ends when end of series reached
- For odd span, output is $n - (span + 1)/2$, shorter than original series



1-D Convolution

Mathematically, express 1-d convolution as a weighted sum over a set of discrete kernel values:

$$s(t) = (x * k)(t) = \sum_{\tau=t-a}^{t+a} x(\tau)k(t - \tau)$$

Where:

$s(t)$ = the output of the convolution operation at time t

x = series of values

k = convolution kernel

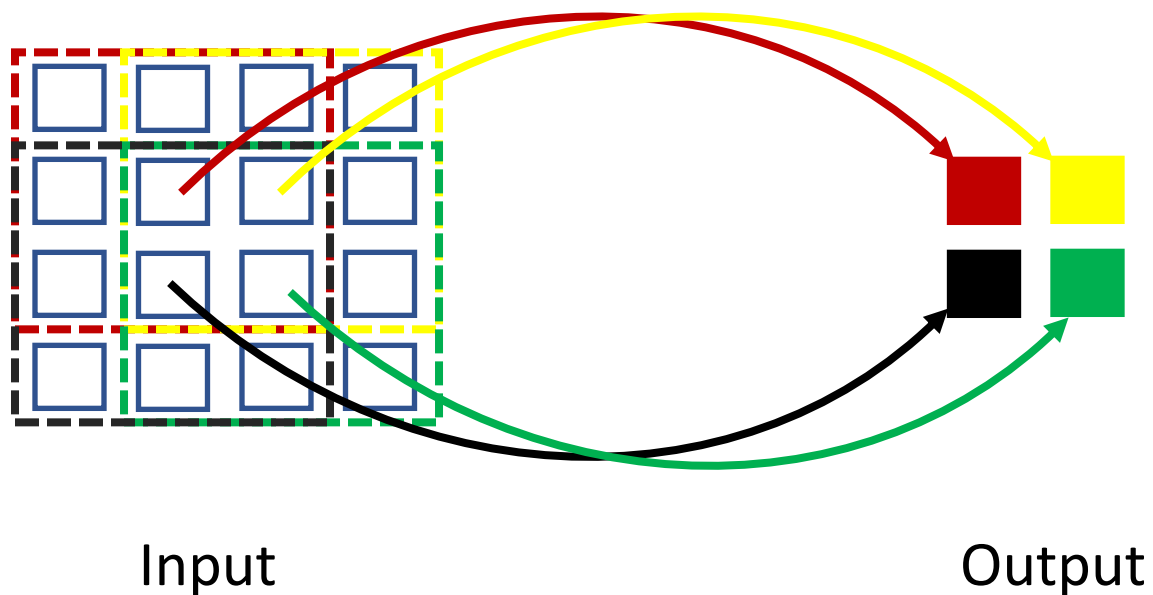
$*$ = convolution operator

τ = time difference of the convolution operator

$a = \frac{1}{2}(\text{span} - 1)$, for odd length operator

2-D Convolution

- 4 x 4 input tensor
- 3 x 3 convolution operator
- 2 x 2 output tensor



2-D Convolution

We can extend convolution to higher dimensions

- Mathematically, we express 2-d convolution as a weighted sum over a discrete rectangular kernel
- For square kernel, $K(i, j)$, of odd dimensions $a \times a$, and $p=(a-1)/2$, convolution can be expressed

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

- Where S , I and K are now 2-dimensional tensors

Algebraic Properties of Convolution

Convolution operations have useful **algebraic properties**

Name	Property
Commutativity	$g * k = k * g$
Associativity	$k * (g * h) = (k * g) * h$
Distributivity	$k * (g + h) = (k * g) + (k * h)$
Associativity of scalar multiplication	$\alpha(k * g) = \alpha k * g$

Notice that these properties are identical to the familiar algebraic properties of multiplication

Stride, Tiling and Padding for Convolution

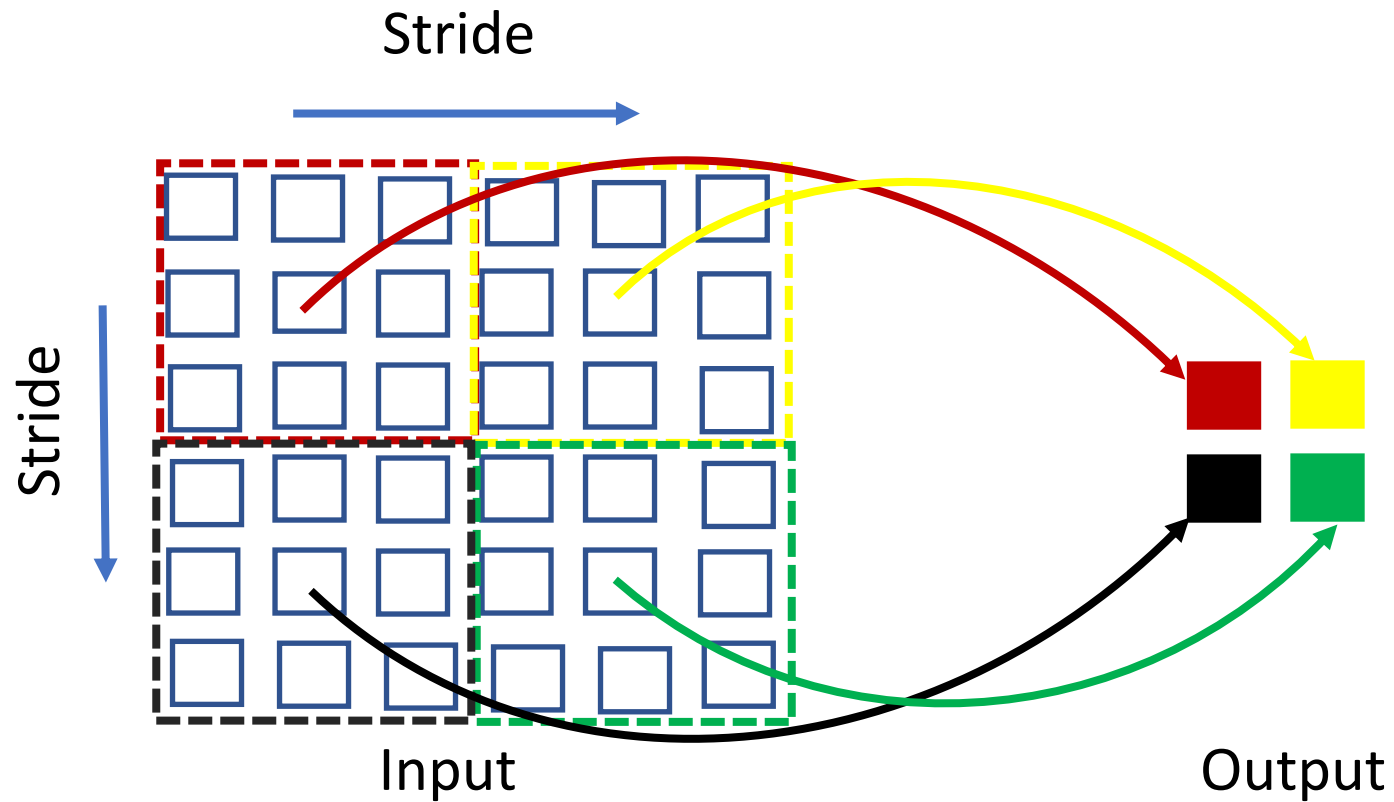
Stride and Tiling

Do we always move the convolution kernel by 1 data value?

- **No!**
 - May not need the full resolution of the input
 - Or, change the dimension of the input tensor
- Stride > 1 **down-samples** the data
 - Output of lower resolution
- Stride < 1 **up-samples** the data
 - Output of higher resolution
- **Stride can be fractional** to create the required output dimension

Stride and Tiling

Tiling is a special case when stride = span:



Stride > 1 reduces dimensionality

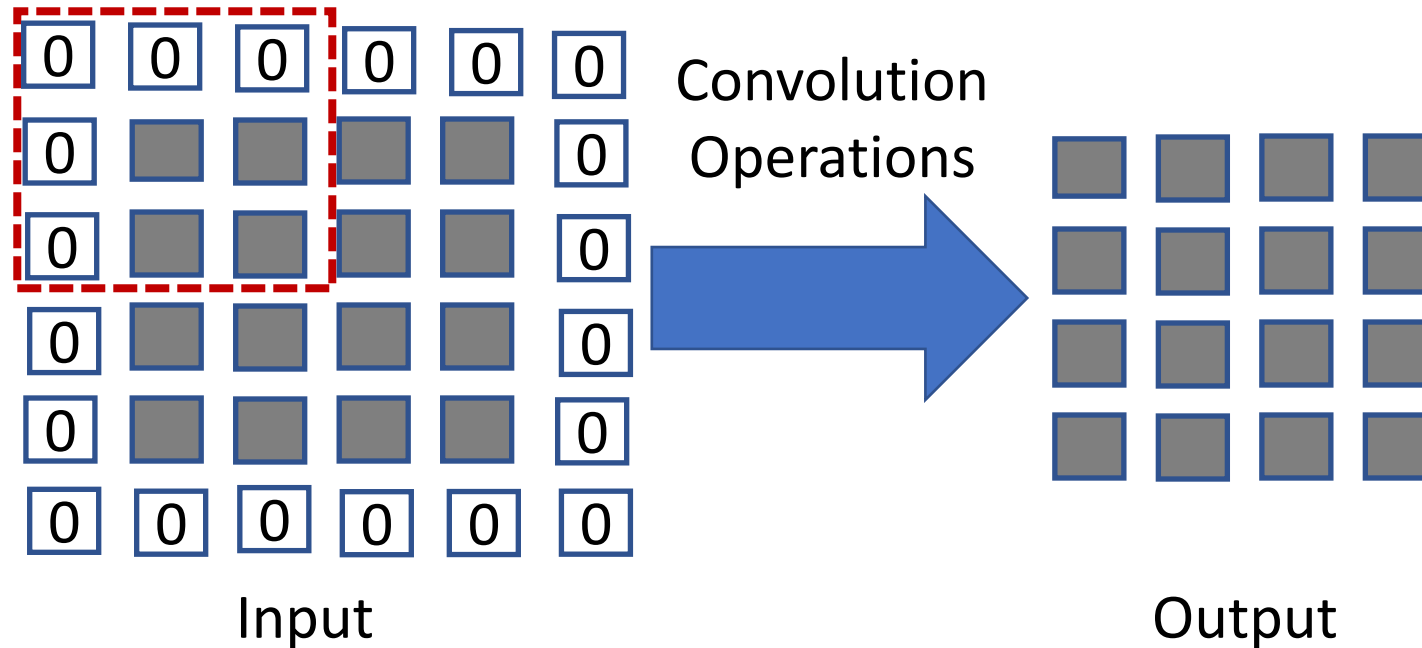
Padding for Convolution

How can we best deal with **edges of the input** tensor when performing convolution?

- A **valid convolution** confines the kernel to the input tensor dimensions
 - For odd kernel shape, output dimension is $(\text{span} + 1)/2$ less than input dimension
 - After many convolution layers, dimension is reduced further
- We can **zero pad** the input tensor
 - Dimensionality is maintained

Padding for Convolution

Example: 4x4 input tensor with 3x3 kernel



- Dimension of output tensor = dimension of input tensor
- 0 values have little effect with max pooling

Commonly Used Convolution Kernels

Common Convolution Kernels

A **moving average kernel** has equal weights

- Example, a 3 x 3 moving average kernel

$$K(i, j) = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- This is also known as a **blur filter** or **box blur**
- Notice the **normalization** so weights add to 1.0

Common Convolution Kernels

A **Gaussian kernel** smooths an image

- Weights computed from Gaussian function with span parameter σ :

$$G(x, y) = \frac{1}{2\pi\sigma^2} e^{-\frac{x^2+y^2}{2\sigma^2}}$$

- Example, a 3 x 3 Gaussian kernel, $\sigma^2 = 1$

$$K(i, j) = \frac{1}{16} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 2 & 4 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Then Gaussian kernel limits the bandwidth and blurs the image
- The larger σ^2 the narrower the bandwidth of the Gaussian kernel

Common Convolution Kernels

The **Sobel kernel** takes the first derivative of the image

- Compute the partial derivatives of the image, G , along each axis

$$\frac{\partial G}{\partial y} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 \end{bmatrix} * G, \quad \frac{\partial G}{\partial x} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & -2 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} * G$$

- Here, $*$, is the convolution operator
- Notice the sum of the weights is 0
- Other derivative kernels can be derived

Common Convolution Kernels

The Sobel kernel is an example of a **separable kernel**

- Notice that we can write a Sobel kernel as the product of two 1-dimensional kernels

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} [1 \quad 2 \quad 1], \quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 2 & 0 & -2 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} [1 \quad 0 \quad -1]$$

- For computational efficiency a 2-dimensional separable kernel can be applied as the convolution of 2 1-dimensional kernels

Median Filter

Median filter is a special case

- Median filter outputs median value of the pixel values within patch
 - Typically use odd patch sizes – e.g., 3 x 3, 5 x 5, 7 x 7
- Median filter is not easily formulated using convolution
 - Use an incremental update algorithm for computational efficiency
- Median filter has interesting properties
 - Suppresses noise
 - Sharpens edges and corners
- Median filter can alter image
 - Response is not isotropic – not same along diagonals of image
 - Can move edges and corners

Image filtering (or convolution)

- Image filtering: compute function of local neighborhood at each position
- Really important!
 - Enhance images
 - Denoise, resize, increase contrast, etc.
 - Extract information from images
 - Texture, edges, distinctive points, etc.
 - Detect patterns
 - Template matching
 - Deep Convolutional Networks

Example: box filter

$K[\cdot, \cdot]$

$$\frac{1}{9}$$

1	1	1
1	1	1
1	1	1

Image filtering

$$K[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$I[\cdot, \cdot]$

$S[\cdot, \cdot]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Image filtering

$I[.,.]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$S[.,.]$

	0	10							

$$K[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Image filtering

$I[.,.]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$S[.,.]$

	0	10	20						

$$K[.,.] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$S(i,j) = (I * K)(i,j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i+m, j+n) K(m,n)$$

Image filtering

$$K[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$I[\cdot, \cdot]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$S[\cdot, \cdot]$

	0	10	20	30					

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Image filtering

$I[.,.]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$S[.,.]$

	0	10	20	30	30				

$$K[.,.] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$S(i,j) = (I * K)(i,j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i+m, j+n) K(m,n)$$

Image filtering

$f[.,.]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$h[.,.]$

	0	10	20	30	30				

$$g[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Image filtering

$$K[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$I[\cdot, \cdot]$

$S[\cdot, \cdot]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

	0	10	20	30	30				
						?			
				50					

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Image filtering

$I[.,.]$

0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	0	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	90	90	90	90	90	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

$S[.,.]$

	0	10	20	30	30	30	20	10	
	0	20	40	60	60	60	40	20	
	0	30	60	90	90	90	60	30	
	0	30	50	80	80	90	60	30	
	0	30	50	80	80	90	60	30	
	0	20	30	50	50	60	40	20	
	10	20	30	30	30	30	20	10	
	10	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	

$$K[\cdot, \cdot] = \frac{1}{9} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$S(i, j) = (I * K)(i, j) = \sum_{m=-p}^p \sum_{n=-p}^p I(i + m, j + n) K(m, n)$$

Box Filter

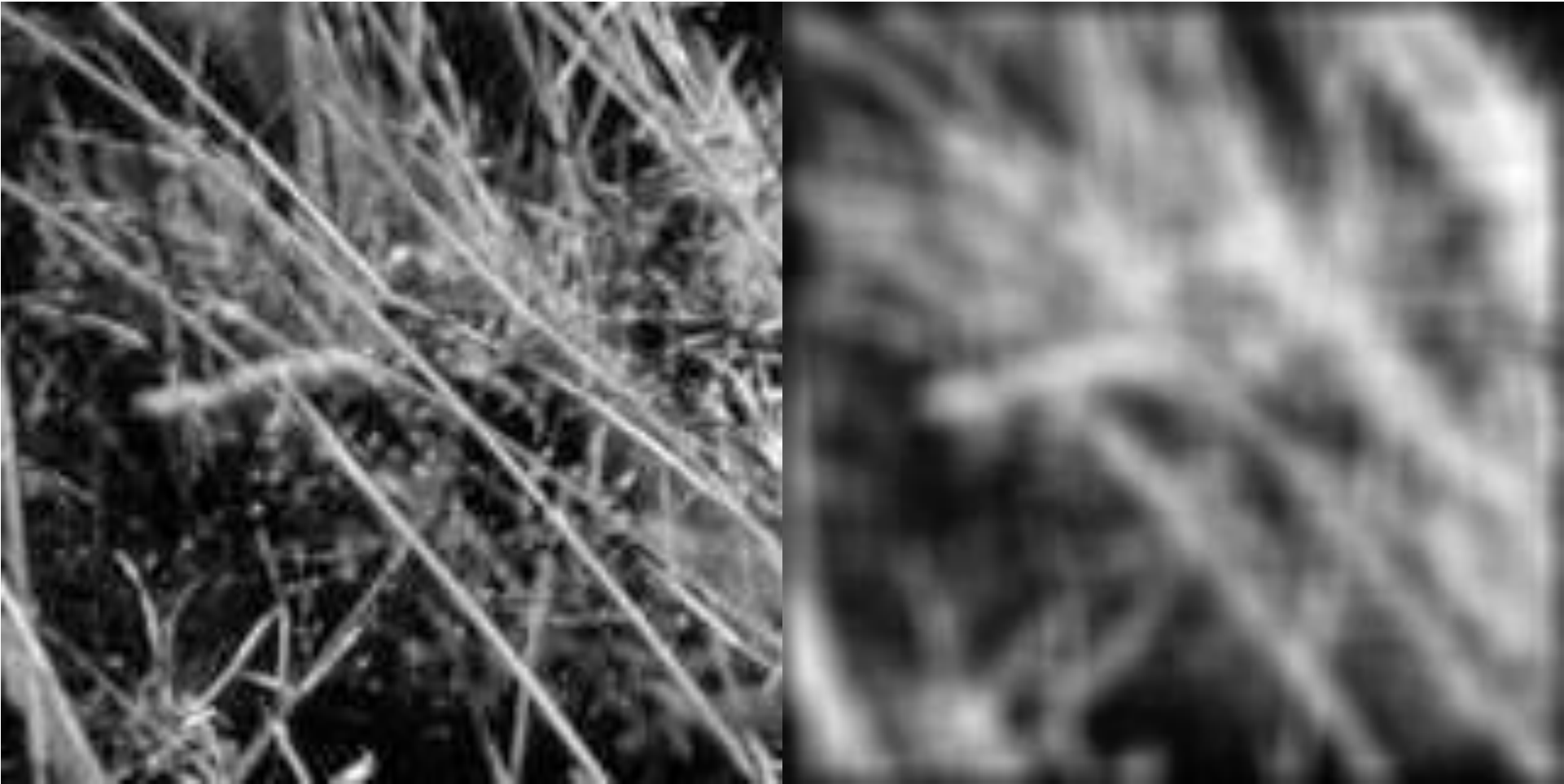
What does it do?

- Replaces each pixel with an average of its neighborhood
- Achieve smoothing effect (remove sharp features)

$$\frac{1}{9} K[\cdot, \cdot]$$

1	1	1
1	1	1
1	1	1

Smoothing with box filter



Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	1	0
0	0	0

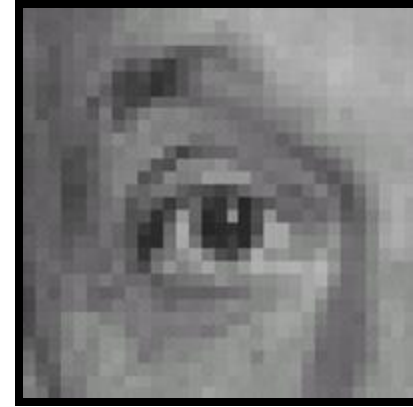
?

Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	1	0
0	0	0



Filtered
(no change)

Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	0	1
0	0	0

?

Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	0	1
0	0	0



Shifted left
By 1 pixel

Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	2	0
0	0	0

—

$\frac{1}{9}$

1	1	1
1	1	1
1	1	1

?

(Note that filter sums to 1)

Practice with linear filters



Original

0	0	0
0	2	0
0	0	0

−

$\frac{1}{9}$

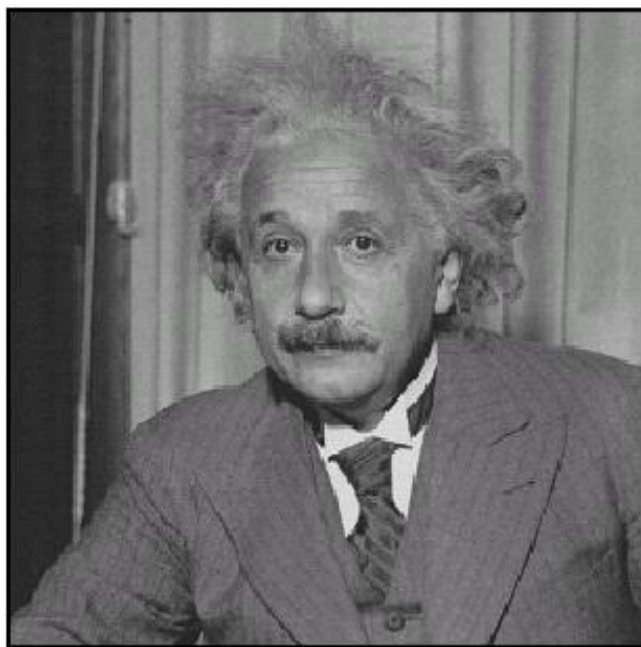
1	1	1
1	1	1
1	1	1



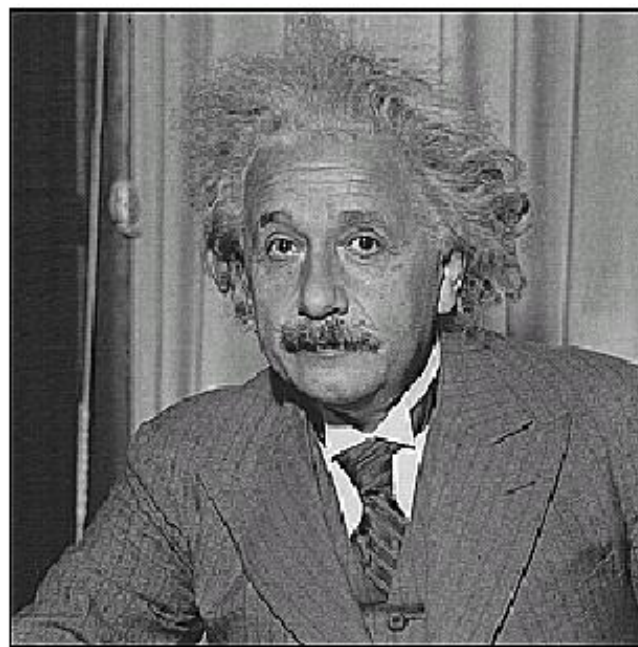
Sharpening filter

- Accentuates differences with local average

Sharpening

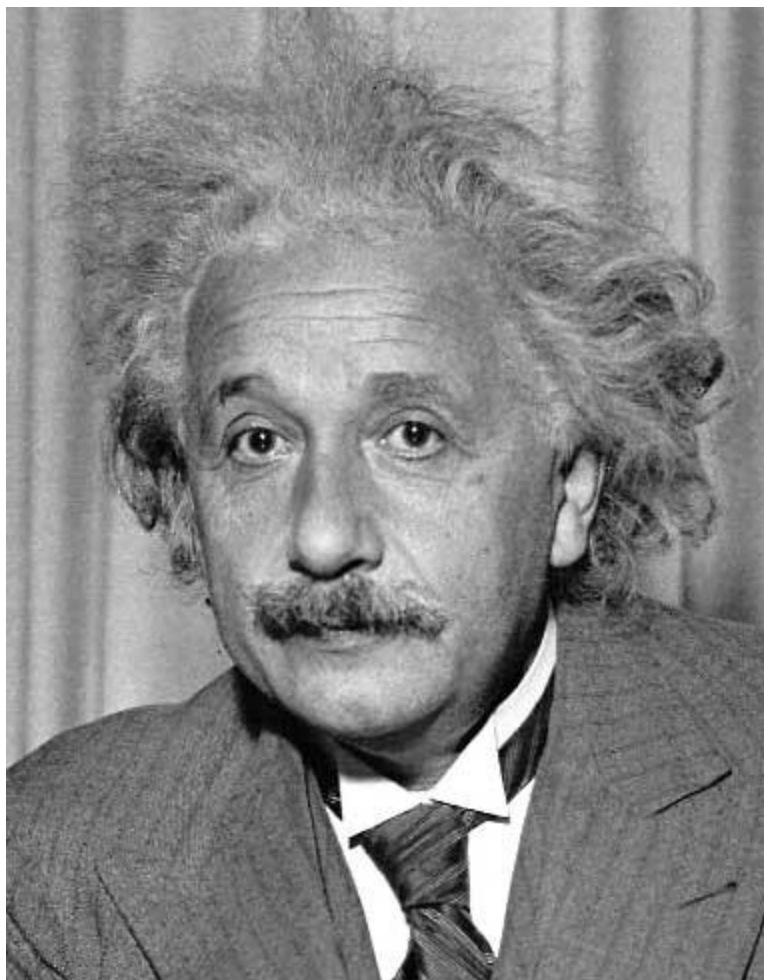


before



after

Other filters



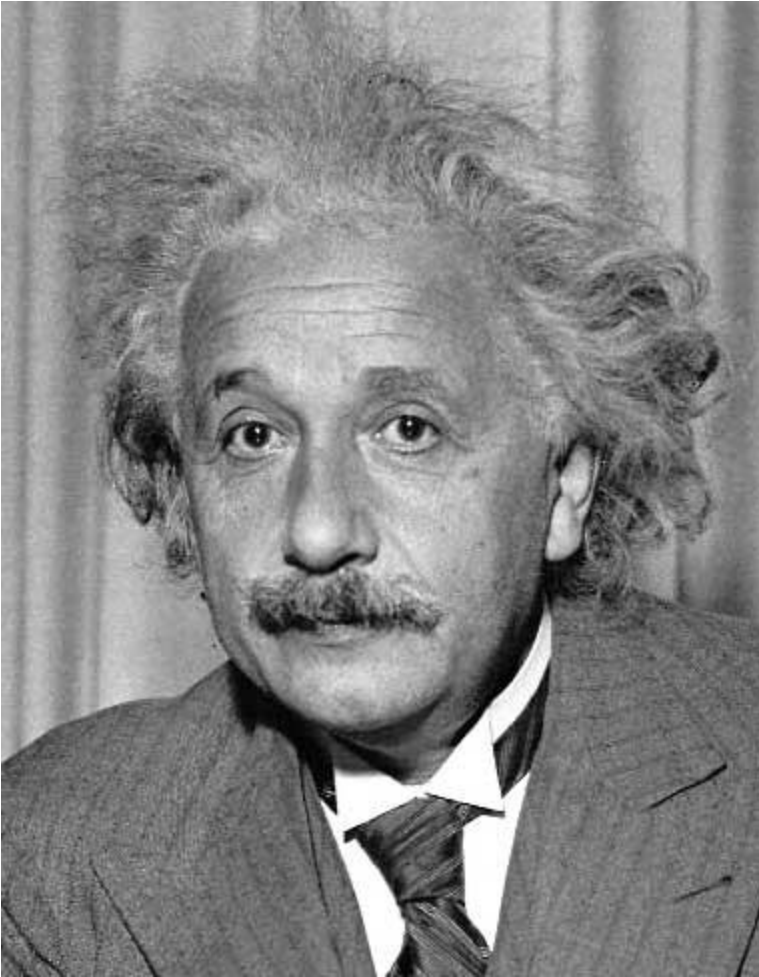
1	0	-1
2	0	-2
1	0	-1

Sobel



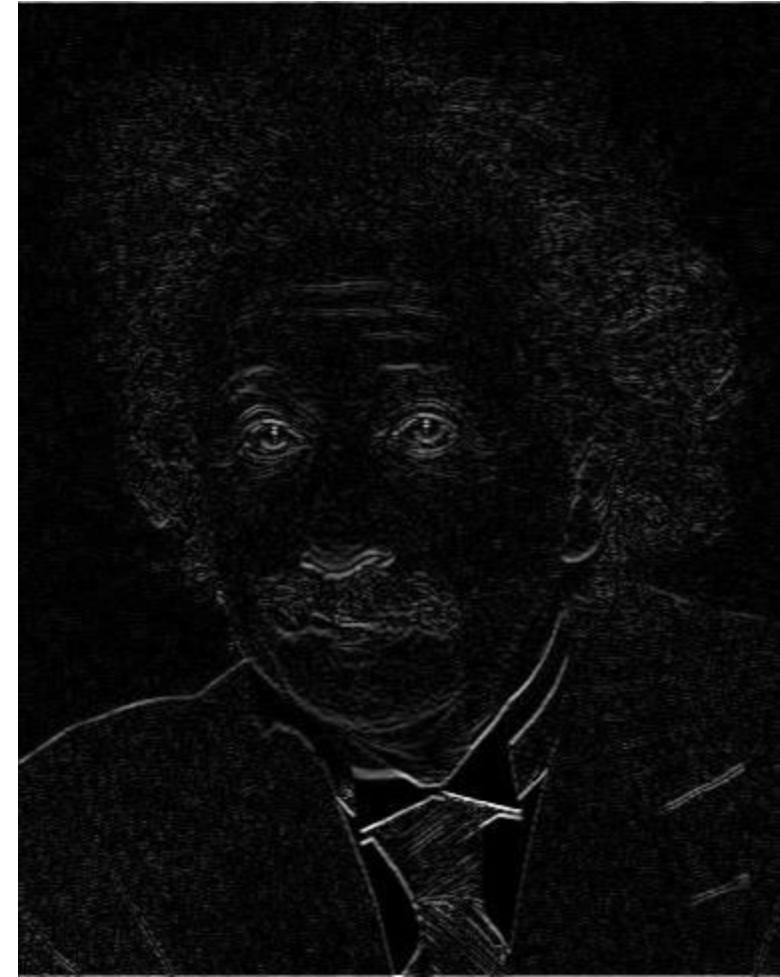
Vertical Edge
(absolute value)

Other filters



1	2	1
0	0	0
-1	-2	-1

Sobel



Horizontal Edge
(absolute value)

Filtering and Spectral Properties of Images

Fourier, Joseph (1768-1830)



French mathematician who discovered that any periodic motion can be written as a superposition of sinusoidal and cosinusoidal vibrations. He developed a mathematical theory of [heat](#) 🔥 in *Théorie Analytique de la Chaleur* (*Analytic Theory of Heat*), (1822), discussing it in terms of differential equations.

Fourier was a friend and advisor of Napoleon. [Fourier believed that his health would be improved by wrapping himself up in blankets, and in this state he tripped down the stairs in his house and killed himself.](#) The paper of [Galois](#) which he had taken home to read shortly before his death was never recovered.

SEE ALSO: [Galois](#)

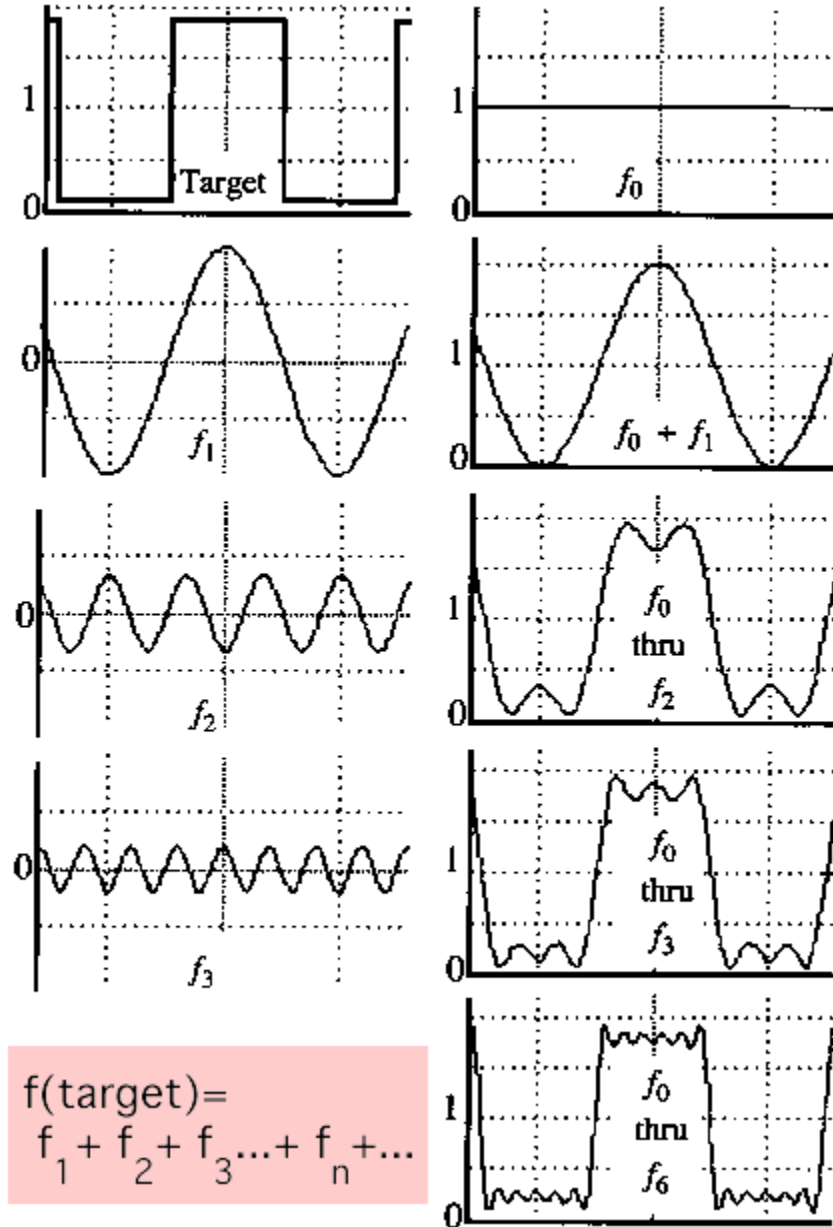
Additional biographies: [MacTutor \(St. Andrews\)](#), [Bonn](#)

A sum of sines

Our building block:

$$A \sin(\omega x + \varphi)$$

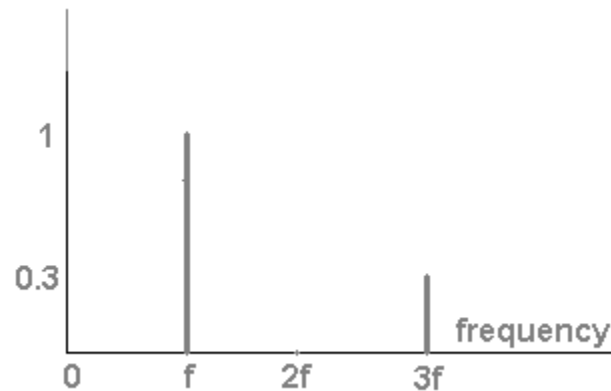
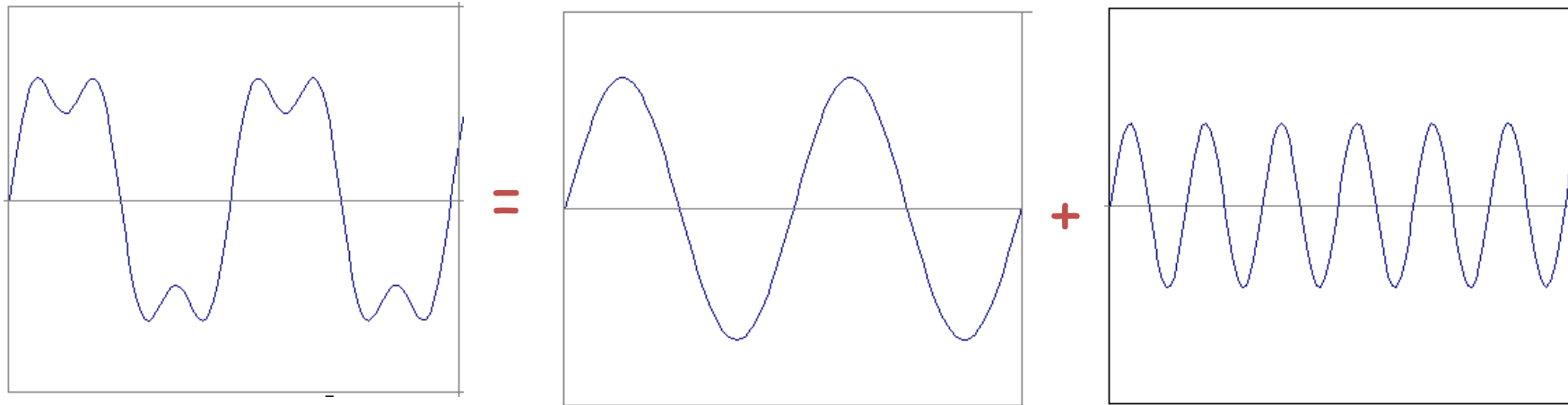
Add enough of them to get
any signal $g(x)$ you want!



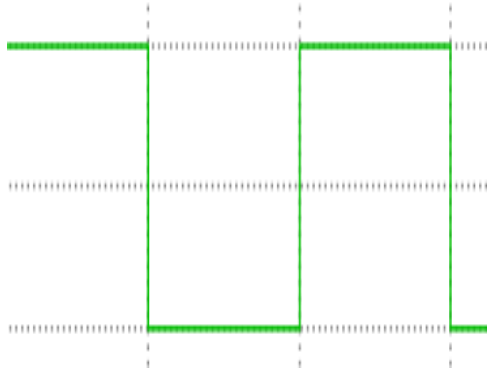
$$f(\text{target}) = f_1 + f_2 + f_3 + \dots + f_n + \dots$$

Frequency Spectra

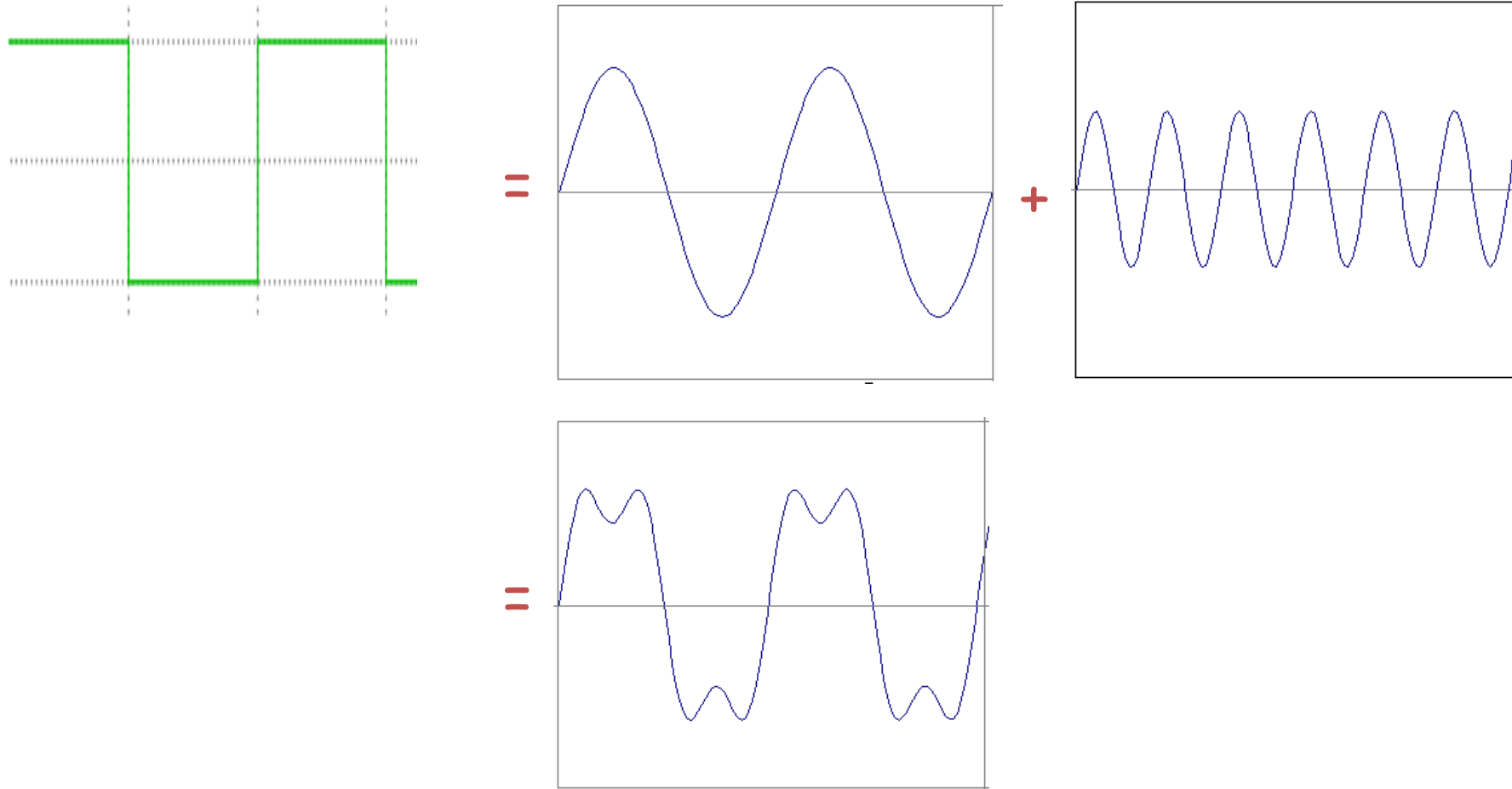
- example : $g(t) = \sin(2\pi f t) + (1/3)\sin(2\pi(3f) t)$



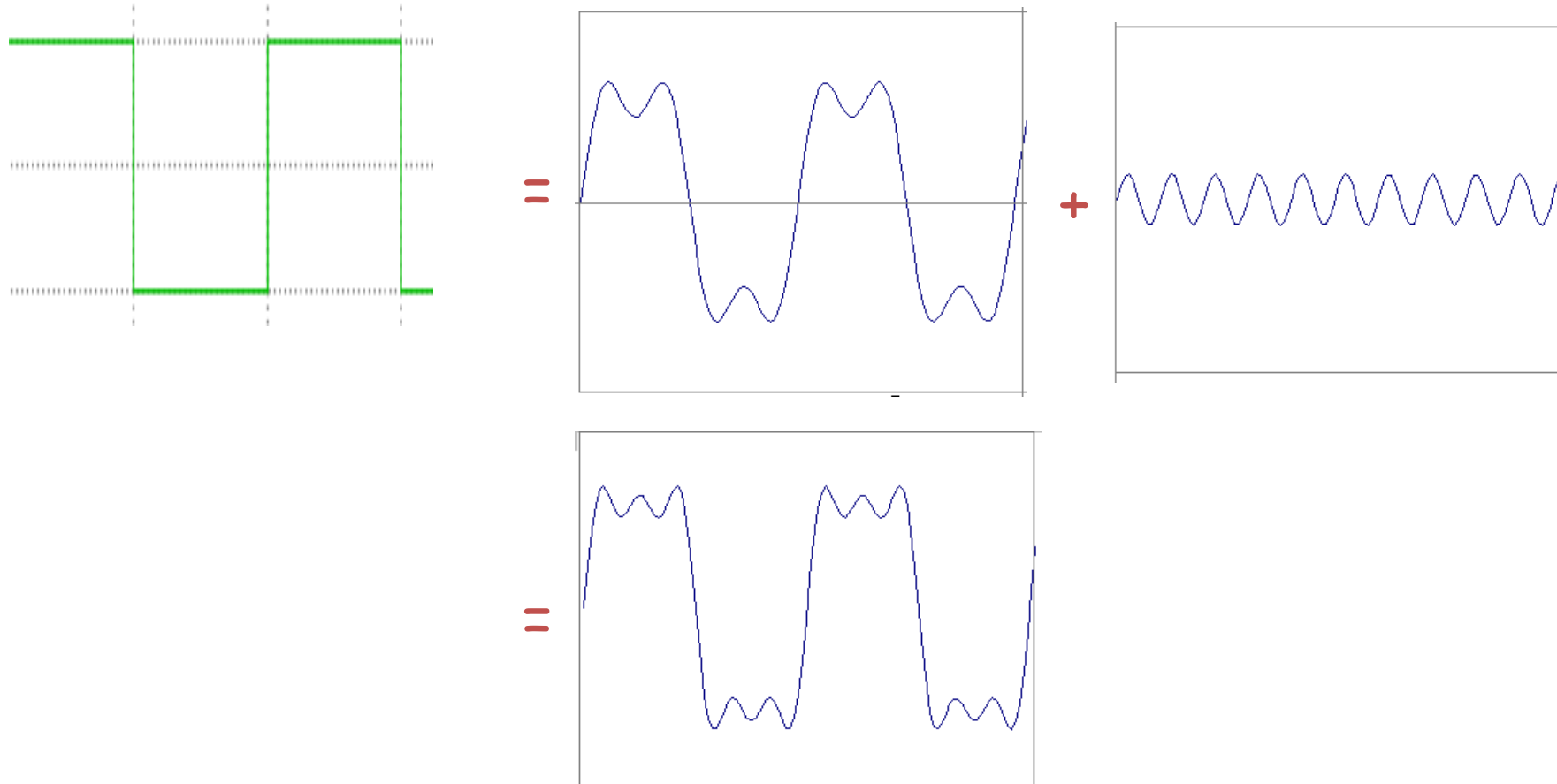
Frequency Spectra



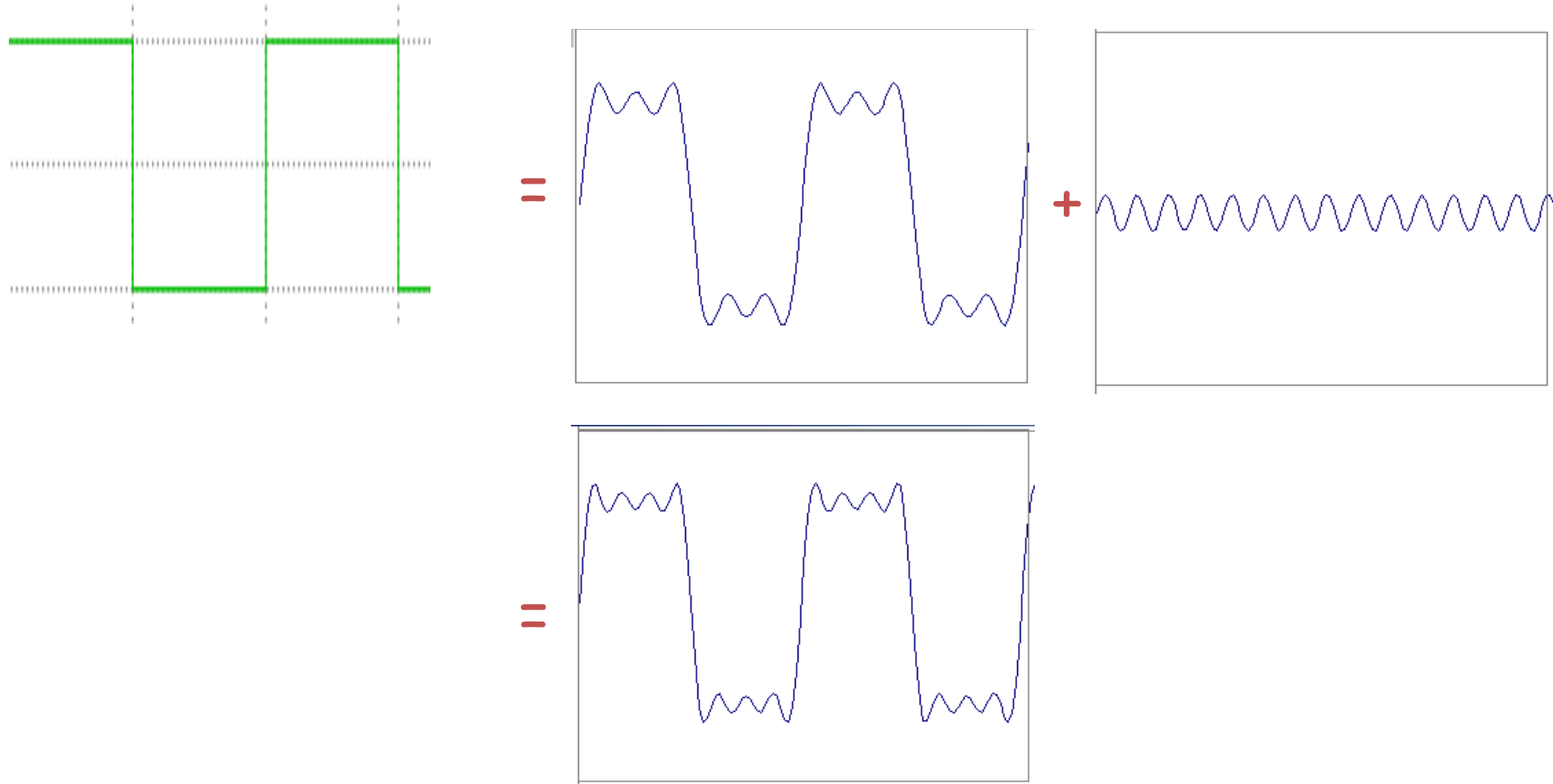
Frequency Spectra



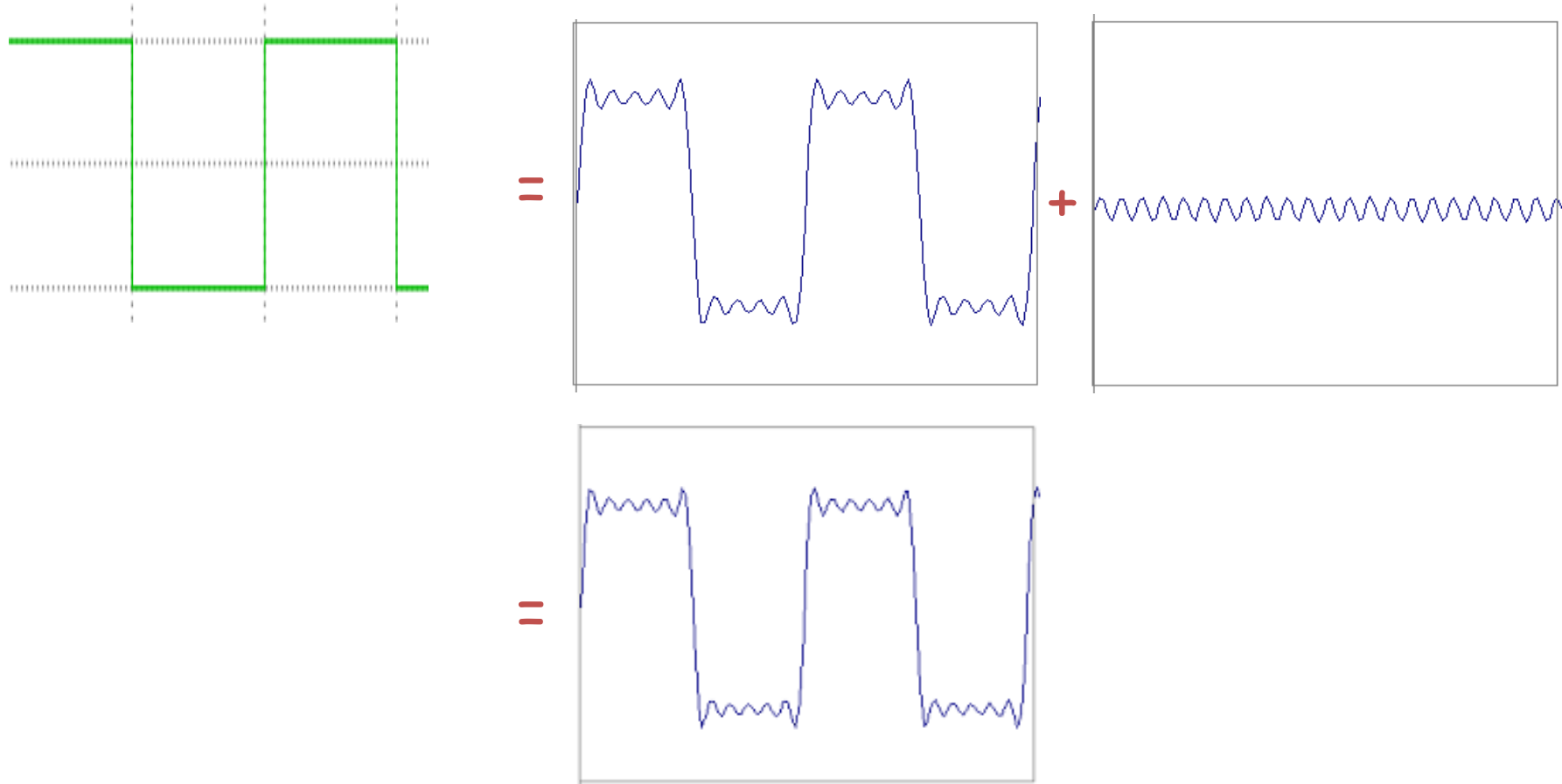
Frequency Spectra



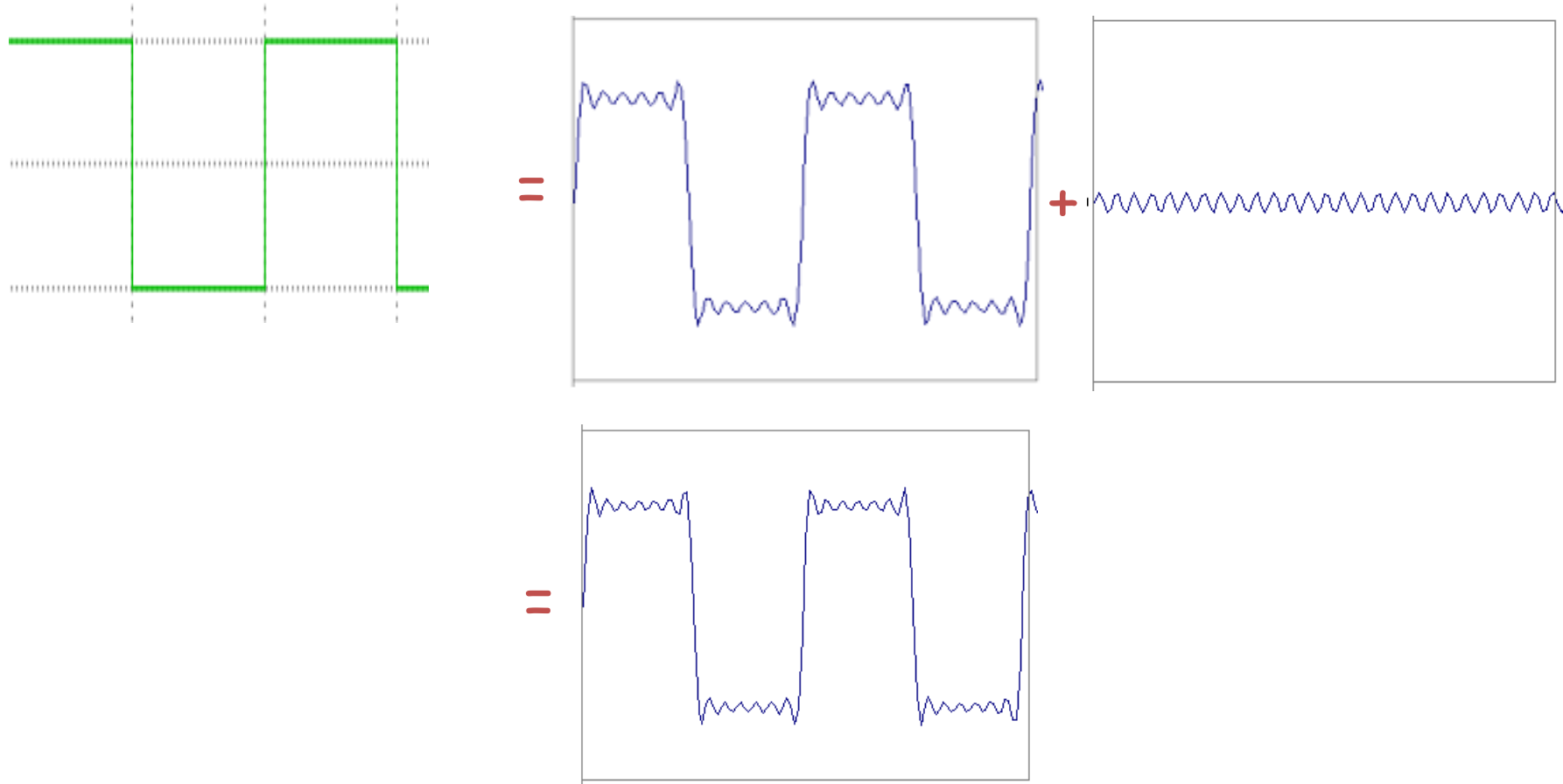
Frequency Spectra



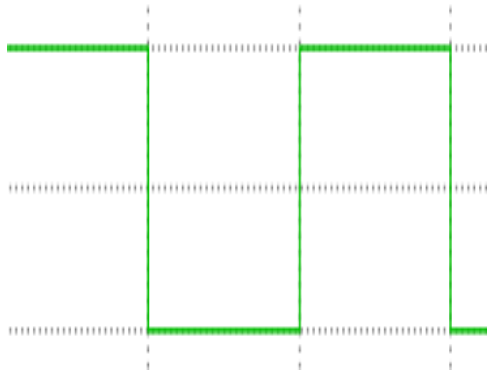
Frequency Spectra



Frequency Spectra

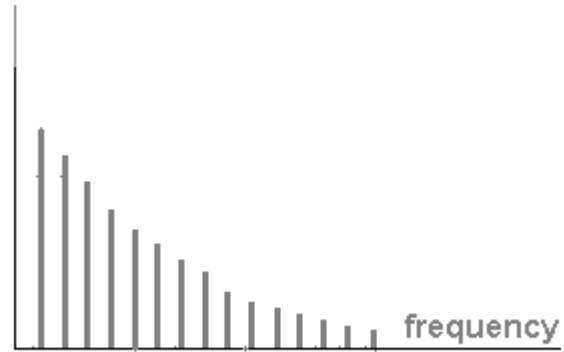


Frequency Spectra



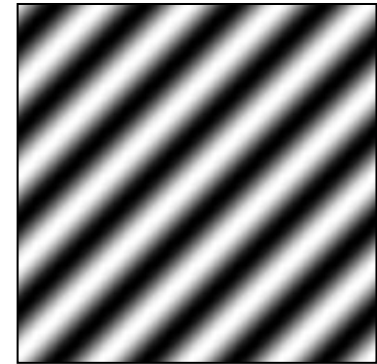
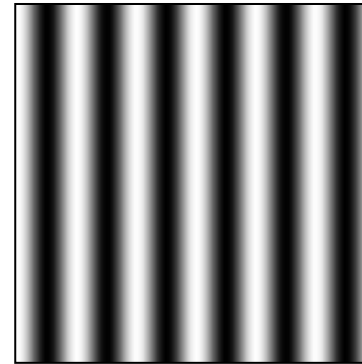
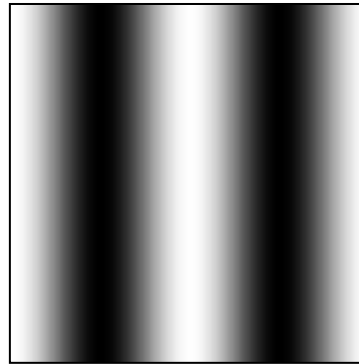
=

$$A \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sin(2\pi kt)$$

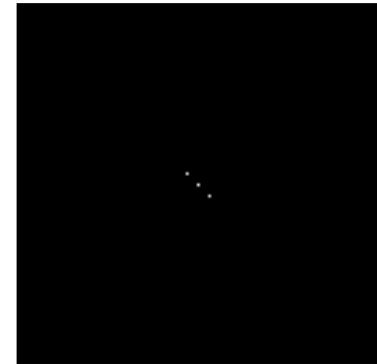
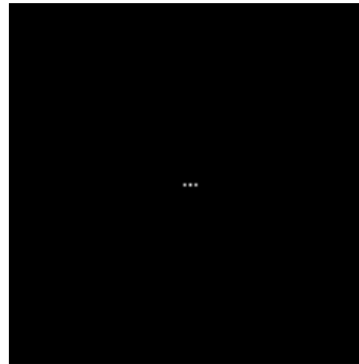


Fourier analysis in images

Intensity Image



Fourier Image



Spectral Properties of Images

The **power spectrum** of an image reveals fundamental properties

- Power spectrum reveals the vertical and horizontal frequency components of the image
- **Low frequency** components of an image represent regions with slowly changing properties
- **High frequency** components of an image arise from **local features** with rapid changes
 - Edges
 - Corners
 - Texture
- **Filtering** changes the power spectrum of an image

Spectral Properties of Images

We can decompose an image into frequency components using a [Fourier transform](#)

- The Fourier transform decomposes a signal into frequency components
- The 1-dimensional Fourier transform of a function, $f(x)$, can be expressed:

$$\hat{f}(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) e^{-2\pi i x \omega} dx$$

- $\hat{f}(\omega)$ is the **complex spectrum** of $f(x)$
 - **Imaginary component** is **phase** at frequency ω
 - **Magnitude** of the complex number is amplitude at frequency ω

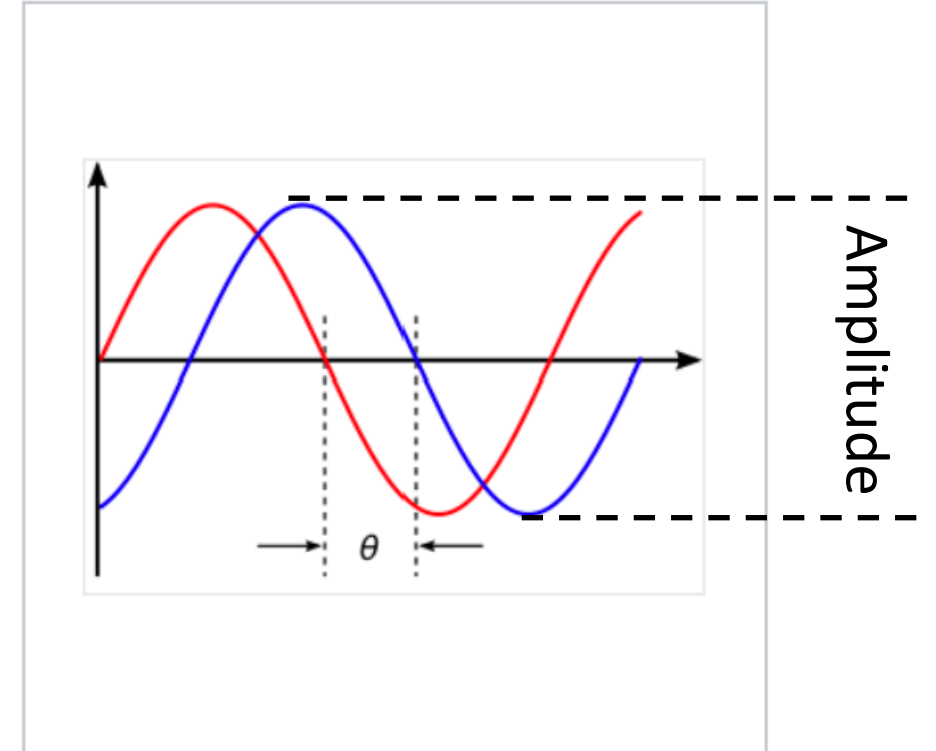
Spectral Properties of Images

We can decompose an image into frequency components using a **Fourier transform**

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 - **Imaginary component** is **phase** at frequency ω
 - **Magnitude** of the complex number is the **signal amplitude** at frequency ω



Two sinusoidal signals with identical frequency and amplitude, phase shifted by θ

Credit, Wikipedia commons

Spectral Properties of Images

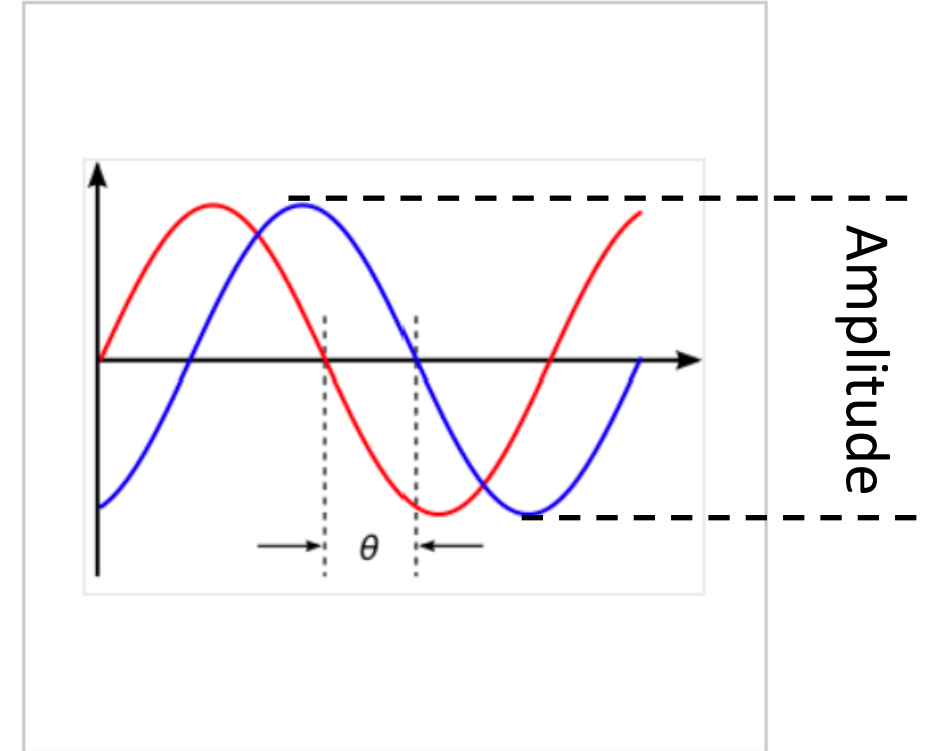
We can decompose an image into frequency components using a [Fourier transform](#)

- The Fourier transform decomposes a signal into frequency components

$$\hat{f}(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) e^{-2\pi i x \omega} dx$$

- For our purposes, we care about the **power spectrum**

$$\overline{S}_{\omega}(\omega) \triangleq |\hat{f}(\omega)|^2$$

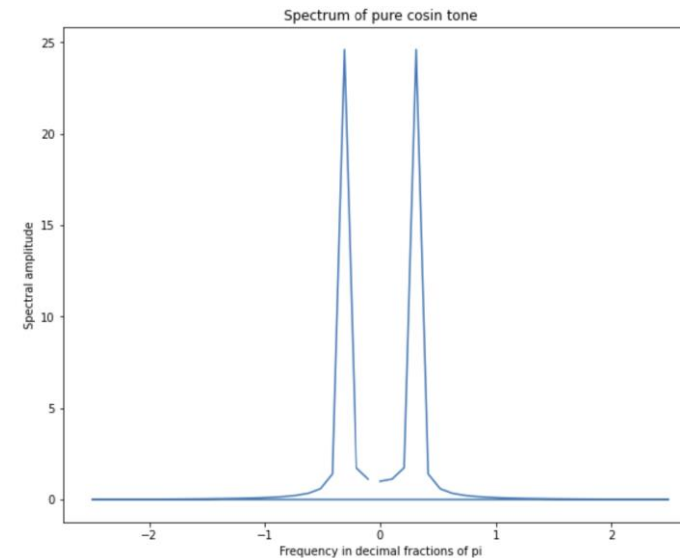
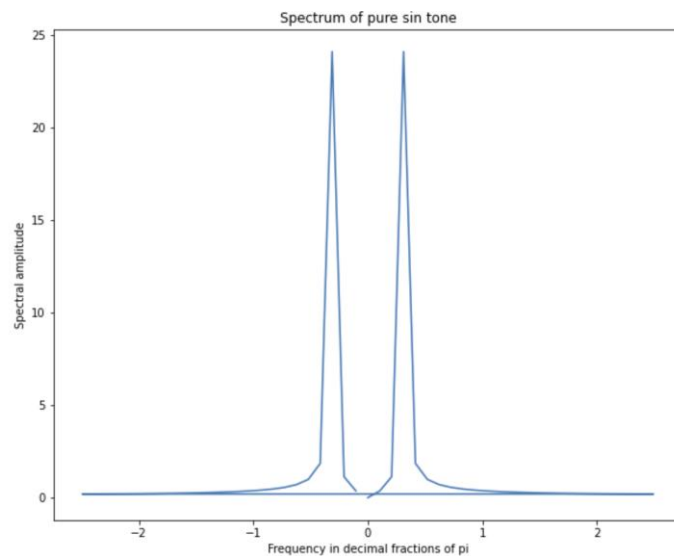
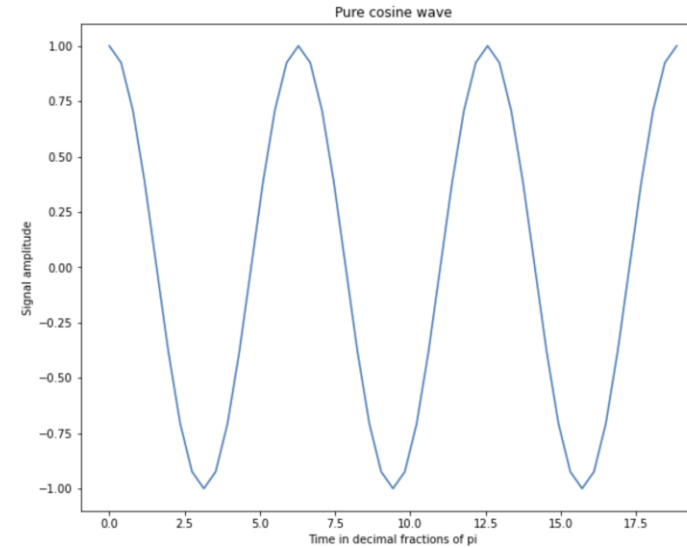
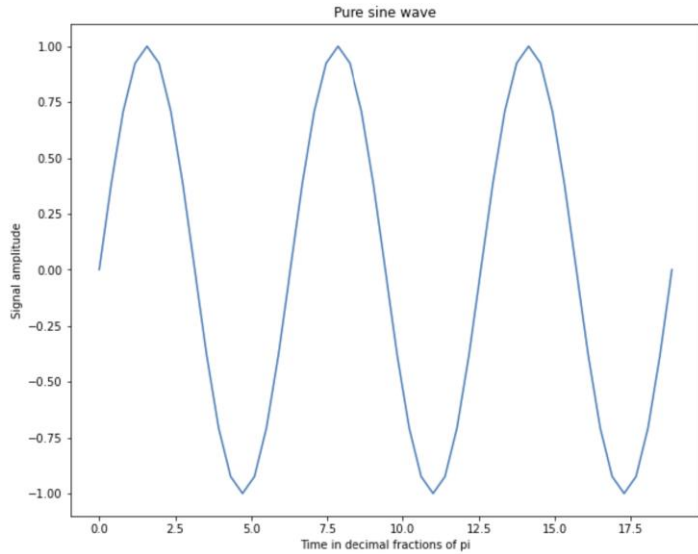


Two sinusoidal signals with identical frequency and amplitude, phase shifted by θ

Credit, Wikipedia commons

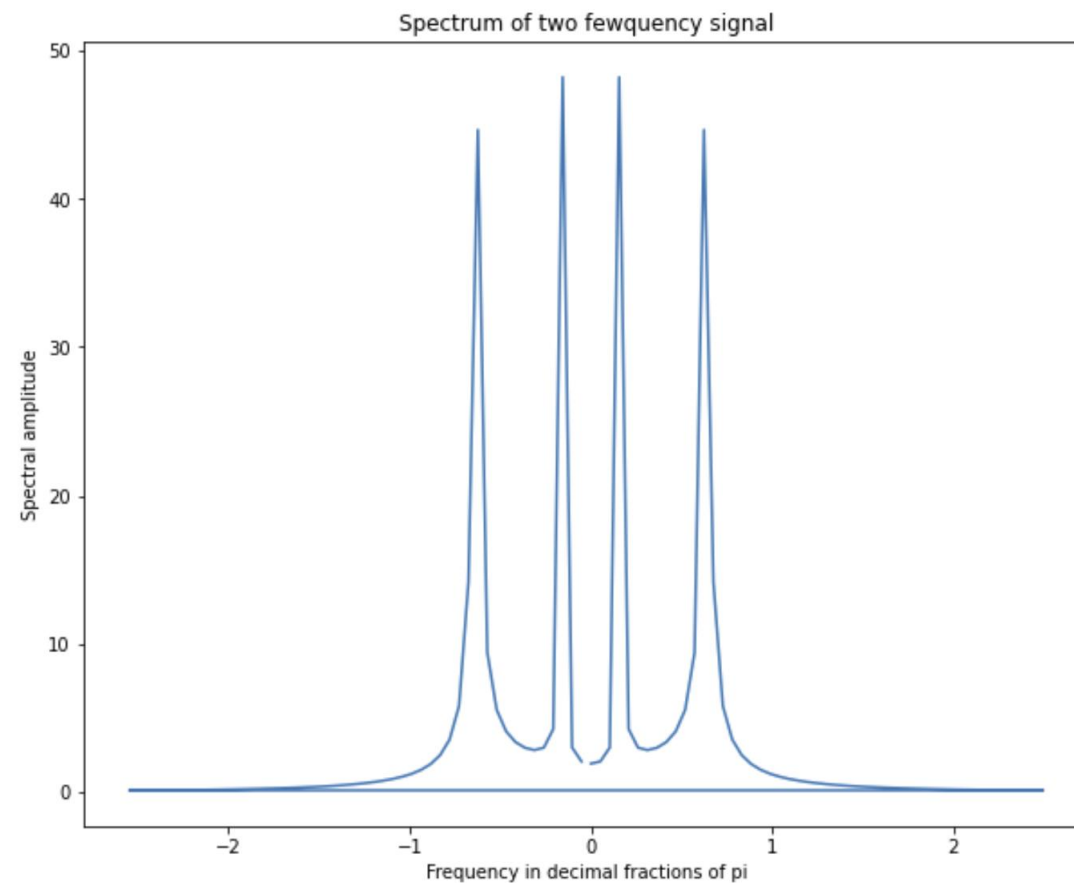
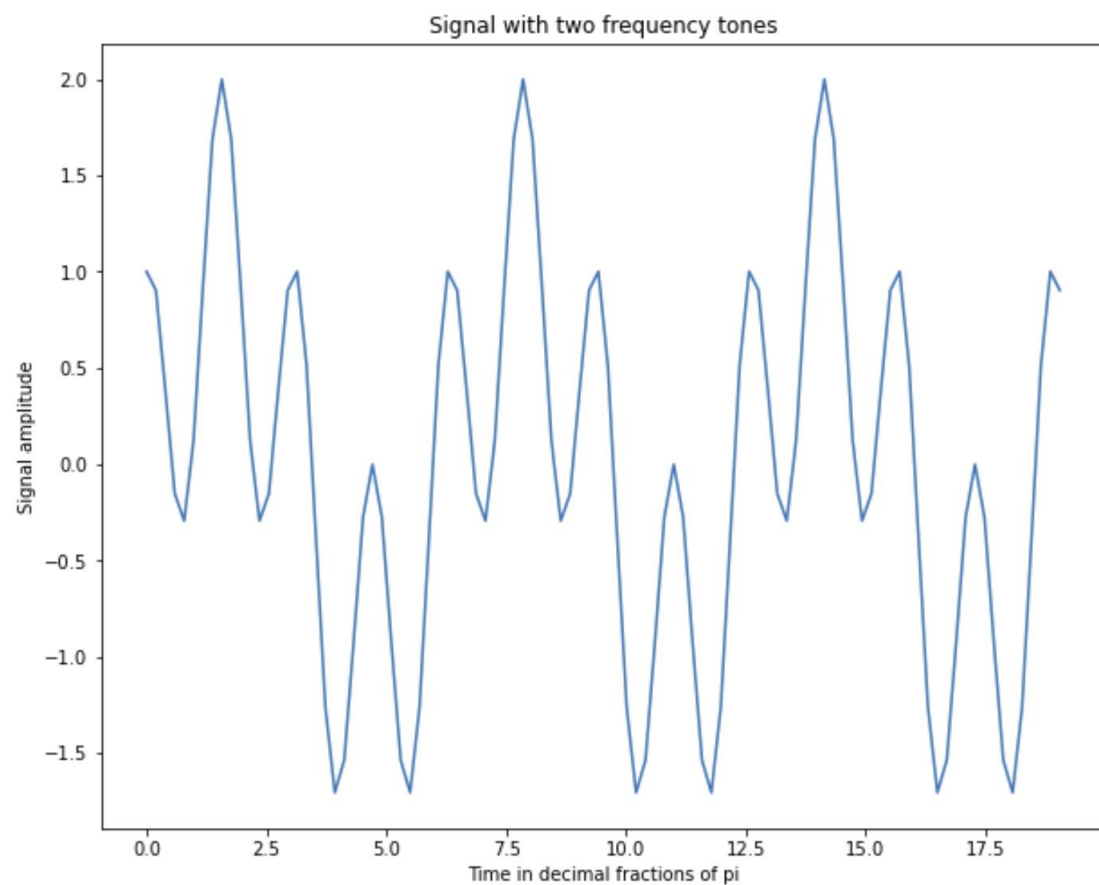
Spectral Properties of Images

Example of single frequency signals and their **power spectrum**



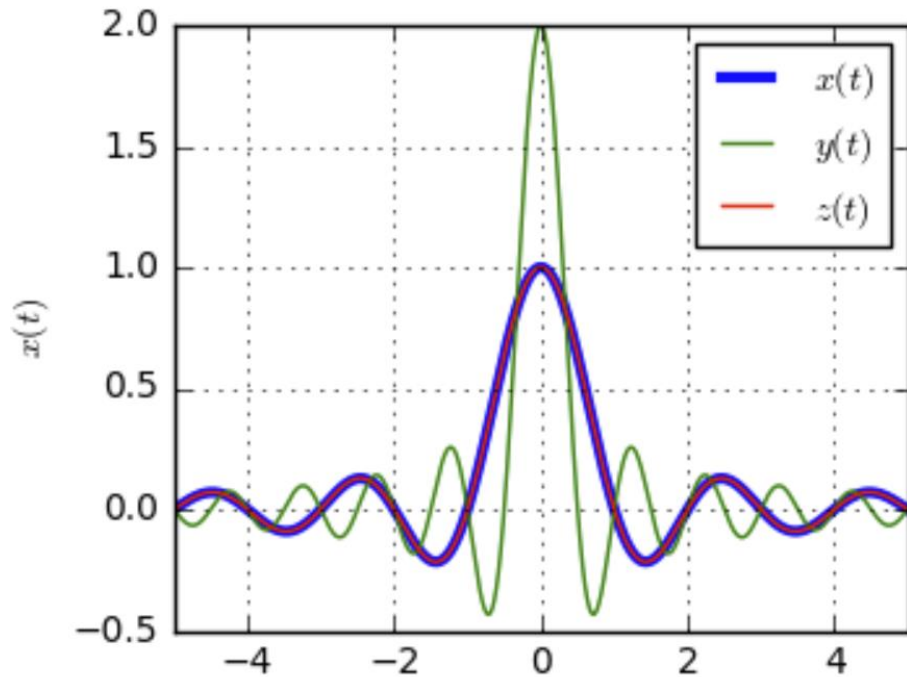
Spectral Properties of Images

Example of signal with two frequencies and the **power spectrum**



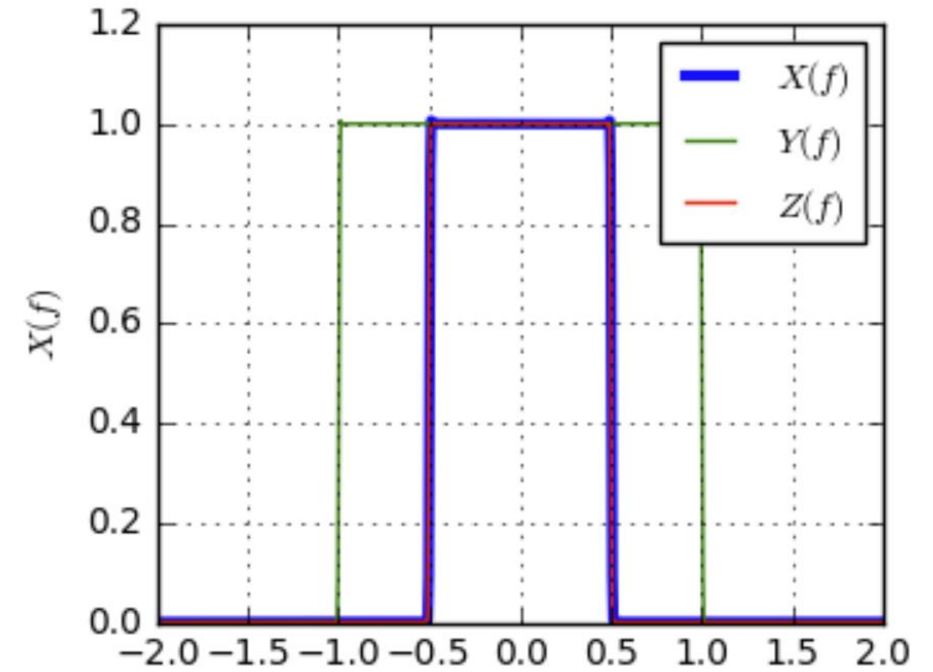
Spectral Properties of Images

Impulse response of convolutional a filter is the Fourier transform in the **frequency domain**



Filter in time domain

Fourier
Transform



Filter in frequency domain

Credit, [DSP Illustrations](#)

Relationship is reversable (inverse Fourier transform) and commutable – exchange time and frequency domain

Spectral Properties of Images

For discretely sampled images we use a 2-dimensional discrete Fourier transform

- The discrete Fourier transform is sampled over image samples (pixels), n_x, n_y , and discrete frequencies, K_x, K_y , within the Nyquist limit:

$$\hat{f}(K_x, K_y) = \sum_{n_x=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{n_y=0}^{N_y-1} f(n_x, n_y) e^{-i\frac{2\pi}{N_x}n_xK_x - i\frac{2\pi}{N_y}n_yK_y}$$

- (n_x, n_y) is the spatial index of a discrete pixel
- K_x, K_y are discrete horizontal and vertical frequencies
- Notice the limited spatial range of the sampling
 - Not $\{-\infty, +\infty\}$
 - Limited spatial sampling introduces edge artifacts – edges of images are impulses

Spectral Properties of Images

For a discretely sampled image we use a [2-dimensional discrete Fourier transform](#)

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- Applying Euler's formula, $e^{-x} = \cos(x) - i \sin(x)$, we get:

$$\hat{f}(K_x, K_y) = \sum_{n_x=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{n_y=0}^{N_y-1} f(n_x, n_y) \left[\cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{N_x}n_xK_x - \frac{2\pi}{N_y}n_yK_y\right) - i \sin\left(\frac{2\pi}{N_x}n_xK_x - \frac{2\pi}{N_y}n_yK_y\right) \right]$$

- This form makes the real (cos) and imaginary or phase (sin) components explicit

Spectral Properties of Images

The **power spectrum** of an image reveals fundamental properties

- [Spectral density](#) reveals the **power or energy** in vertical and horizontal frequency components of the image

$$\overline{S_{K_x, K_y}}(K_x, K_y) \triangleq |\hat{f}(K_x, K_y)|^2$$

- In words, the spectral density is the lag-1 autocorrelation of the estimated Fourier transform, $\hat{f}(K_x, K_y)$
- Or square of the absolute value of the estimated Fourier transform

Spectral Properties of Images

The **power spectrum** of an image reveals fundamental properties

- [Spectral density](#) reveals the **power or energy** in vertical and horizontal frequency components of the image given the estimated Fourier transform, $\hat{f}(\omega)$

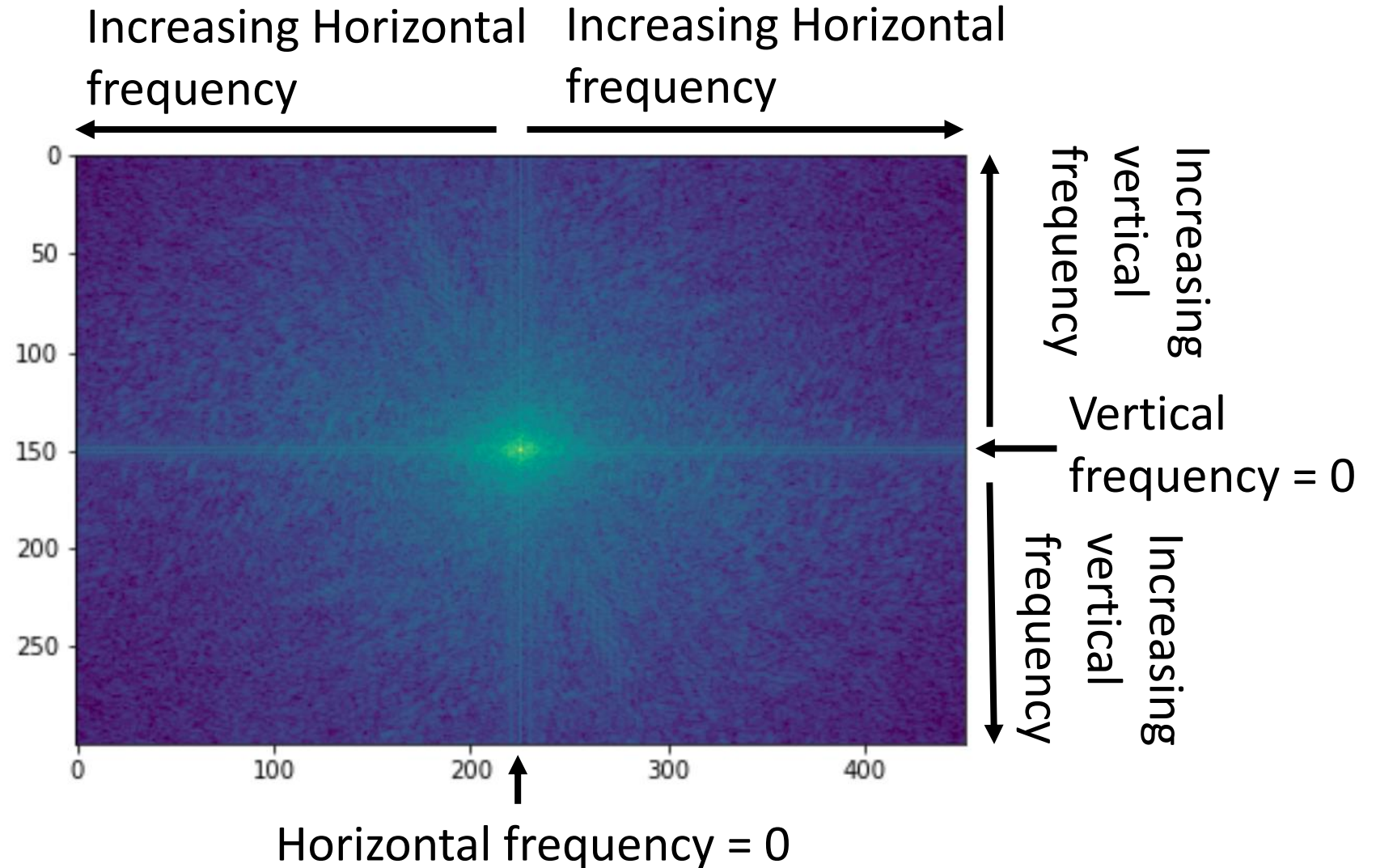
$$\overline{S_{K_x, K_y}}(K_x, K_y) \triangleq |\hat{f}(K_x, K_y)|^2$$

- Spectral density is easier to work with, since it just gives us the power at each frequency, K_x, K_y
 - The squared magnitude of the signal at K_x, K_y
- Notice that, unlike Fourier transform, the spectral density is not invertible
 - The square of absolute magnitude of $\hat{f}(K_x, K_y)$ loses phase information

Spectral Properties of Images

Spectral density reveals the **power or energy** in vertical and horizontal frequency components of the image

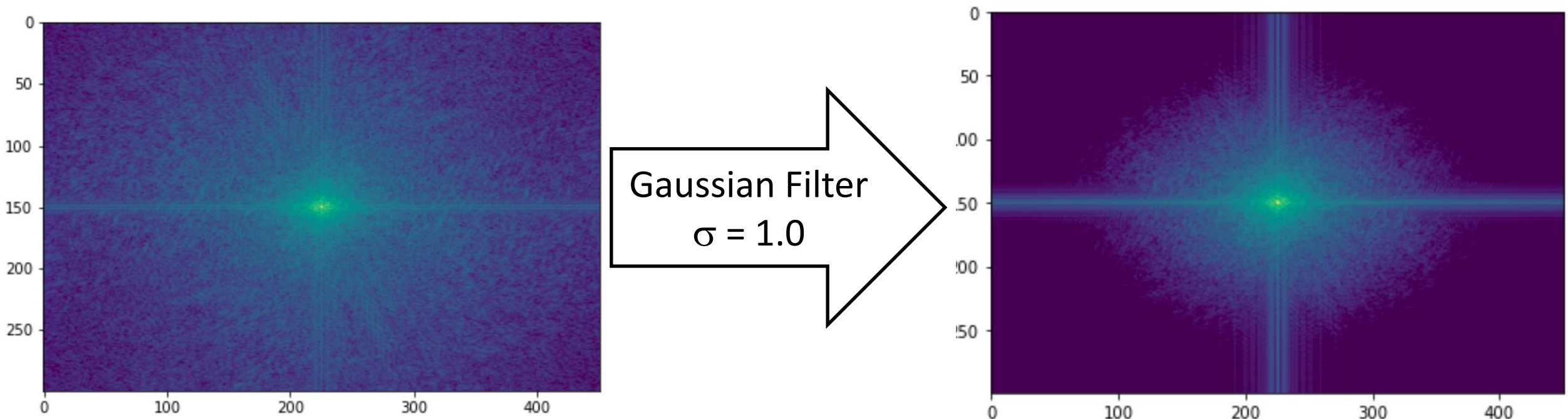
- For real-valued image, spectral density is symmetric about zero frequency
- Rapid changes (e.g. edges, corners) have high frequency components



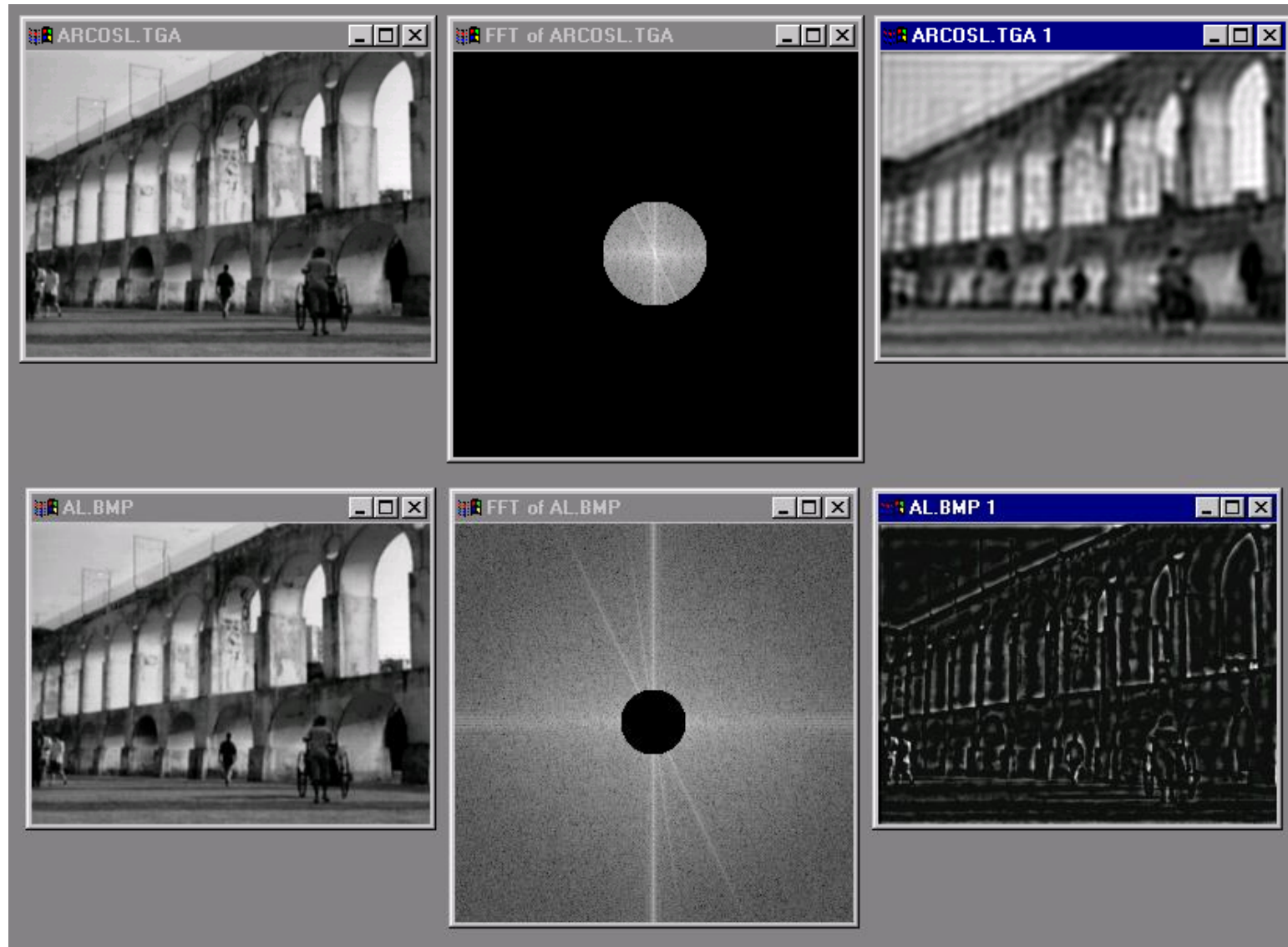
Spectral Properties of Images

Changes in spectral density show the **effect of filtering**

- Filters change the spectral characteristics of images
- Filters can **suppress unwanted high frequency noise**
- Filtering **reduces aliasing**
- Lower frequency image is **blurred** – edges and corners less sharp



Low and High Pass filtering



The Convolution Theorem

There is a direct relationship between filtering in the spatial (or time) domain and the frequency domain, the [convolution theorem](#)

- For spatial domain image, $f(x, y)$, its Fourier transform, $\hat{f}(\omega_x, \omega_y)$, operating on by a spatial domain convolutional kernel, $k(x, y)$, its Fourier transform, $\hat{k}(\omega_x, \omega_y)$, we can state the convolution theorem:

$$\begin{aligned}(f * k)(x, y) &\Leftrightarrow \hat{f}^{-1}(\hat{f} \cdot \hat{k}) \\ (f \cdot k)(x, y) &\Leftrightarrow \hat{f}^{-1}(\hat{f} * \hat{k})\end{aligned}$$

- In words, the convolution theorem states that convolution in the spatial domain is equivalent to the inverse Fourier transform of the point wise product in the frequency domain, or vice versa
- The convolution theorem helps us understand the effects of filtering

Summary

Key points for this lesson

- How convolutional works in 1-d, 2-d and higher dimension
- How to apply padding, stride and tiling for convolution
- Constructing convolutional filter kernels
- The relationship between filtering and the spectrum of images